

Cold email still works if you stop overcomplicating it

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All right, cold email still works, but only if you stop over complicating it. This will be the exact system that I use

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to this day and have taught thousands of reps to book meetings consistently through email, despite the environment

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for email becoming much tougher recently. So, this will be a no fluff, no BS. You will have templates,

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cadences, follow-ups to implement right away after this if you choose to do so. So, we're going to start with the

Cold email foundations and key inputs

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foundations of cold email outreach and understanding the power of cold email and the key inputs that go into success,

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some of the common pitfalls to avoid. They're very easy to avoid. They're way too common. We're going to cover that

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and then we're going to get right into the cold email blueprint. We're going to have tons where there's going to be no

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room for interpretation. You will have tons of email template examples to implement. We're going to talk about persona levels, which I haven't done

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much on this channel, but it's kind of the next step once you get the base framework in place, follow-up examples,

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the concept of an email objection bank, like how to respond to objections when you receive them via email, subject

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lines, and then calendar invites, which is an overlooked topic, but hugely important. They're emails. Most people

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don't do them right, and they cost themselves tons of meetings. So, we're going to cover a toz. Let's get into it.

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But first, if you want more hands-on guidance throughout this after seeing it, implementing the ABAB cadence

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working with me directly, you can check out the link in the description to cold email engine. I lead the live calls in

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there. More on that later, but let's get right into it. And first, I don't think a lot of people are giving up on cold

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email. They think it's dead. They think AI has killed it. Everyone's blasting out emails and automated junk. And to

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some extent, that's true. But most people don't get why email is still a very valuable outreach method and they

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don't understand the key inputs. So the advantages to cold email, some of these may seem obvious, but especially if

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you're new and you're just getting going with email outbound or just outbound in general, email is the fastest channel to

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start generating meetings and consistent results if you do it right. I still think cold calling is the highest value

Why email is still one of the fastest channels to book meetings

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form of prospecting, but it takes time to get good at it and comfortable with it. If you get a relevant message into

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the hands of relevant personas frequently via cold email, even if you don't even know what you're doing yet,

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you will get replies and you will book meetings. It's also extremely scalable. As you'll see in the example below,

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slight improvements will drive massive outsized impact. I learned this as an SDR manager when I was managing 13 reps

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at any given time. And I understood if I could get the average reply rate from 5% to 6% as an example, what the downstream

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effect with that would be on meetings and pipeline generated. It's easy to systematize. Let me caveat that. It's

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hard, but once you learn how to do it, it's actually very easy to systematize it without requiring a huge time

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investment. You can get lots of emails out the door, like a hundred a day in less than an hour manually if you know

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how to systematize it. And then you can craft your message with tone and precision. So on cold calls, for

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example, you got to know what you're doing on the fly. If someone gives you an objection, you got to be able to respond to it right on the fly. Over

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email, you they don't even know. There's no tonality, at least audibly via email.

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So you can take the time to craft a good message. You have more time behind the scenes. But let me get into why cold

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email the inputs, why they're so powerful. This is a very basic example in cold email engine. I actually have a

Small improvements that lead to outsized results

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spreadsheet you can play around with with different variables. And if I got my response rate up to this or my reply

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rate or meeting book rate up to from five to six or six to seven, what would the downstream impact be? But look at

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scenario one where rep sends 150 emails, let's call it in a week, they get a 4%

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response rate to that. So one out of 25 people reply and on average one out of five of those people who reply book a

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meeting. You are on average expected to get 1.2 two meetings per week over email if those are your results. For some of

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you maybe that's pretty good. Others that may seem low. But just by improving some of these inputs, let's say we

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structure our day and systematize things so we're just slightly more productive. So we go from 150 to 250 emails sent per

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day. That's an extra 20 per day. That's so doable. Response rate goes from 4% to

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five. So instead of 1 out of 25, 1 out of 20. And the meeting conversion goes from 20% to 22%. These are things you

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wouldn't even notice on a day-by-day, week-by-week basis, but your average expected meetings per week jumps from

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1.2 to 2.75 per week ongoing if you are

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able to just make these slight improvements. So, that's why I look at the little details so carefully because

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every little detail, email is a scale game. We're trying to do highquality outreach at scale. these little

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seemingly meaningless improvements drive that's I don't know what that's like a 150% 250% increase in results. So this

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is why I obsess over the small details with email prospecting. Small improvements lead to massive impacts on

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your results. So furthermore question pause test. What is the key input to

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booking email meetings? Maybe drop it in the comments if you haven't cheated yet. But the answer is responses. Responses

The number one driver of meetings over email

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are almost the equivalent to answer rate on cold calls. To book a meeting via the phone, you got to get someone to answer.

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To book a meeting or have a chance at booking a meeting over email, you need someone to respond. And that might seem

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obvious, but a lot of the way you guys are taught to write emails is not geared around getting a response or getting a

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response to your request to meet if your goal is to set meetings. So, your email

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language and tone should be designed to trigger a response, particularly around

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your request to meet. This is the cold email version of shots on net. You're not getting any shots on net if no one's

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responding to your emails. There's nothing more demoralizing than spending a week sending 150 emails a day and not

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getting any replies. More replies gives you more chances to book meetings. This seems so obvious, I'm sure, but you have

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to you have to go back first principles and reverse engineer what we're trying to accomplish here. A response is what

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puts you on the playing field and gives you that nonzero probability to book the meeting. You need people to be engaging

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with your message. And furthermore, with these responses, you will

never convert them. That's not the goal. You're you're

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not trying to bat 800. Just the same way an MLB player is not going for that. You're never going to convert the

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majority of them, and that's normal. But again, if you increase your reply rate from 2% to 4%, all else equal, same

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number of emails, same conversion rate after they reply, you just doubled the amount of meetings that you're booking.

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So, we want to tackle these inputs one by one. So, the reason and if you're

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here and you're not getting enough replies, here's a couple of the common frameworks that are taught and why they

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don't get replies. The first common example, and there's a million variations of these, but you'll hear it. It's this is the LinkedIn sales guru.

Why common outreach frameworks fail

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You'll see this non-stop on LinkedIn. It's like personalization, observation, problem insight, social proof, soft CTA,

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the whole show me, you know me thing. And it sounds something like, "Hey, John, noticed your their company's been growing their delivery ops. Curious if

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your team is still coordinating drivers and routes manually. we've been tracking or we've been working with companies

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similar to blank link to some customer success story you have that's the same as every other sales rep that's reaching

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out to reduce dispatcher workload and cut admin time using simple tracking workflows that don't require a full

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system overhaul. Would it make sense to take a quick look together? So,

this is not strong enough. You're not implying a

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meeting. You're not even implying that you need a reply. You're basically
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sounds fake spray and prey. It's fake personalized. You can't do this at
scale. This framework can work if you

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have truly have three to five very specific people you're reaching out to
and your personalized observation is

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actually very on point. But if you're trying to send high volume email
outreach, high quality at scale, that

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they're going to sniff this out 100 times out of 100. This is what I see in
my email inbox all the time. It's fake

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personalized. It has the actual opposite effect of what you're going for.
The other most common example of why emails

Passive language that kills reply rates

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don't get replies. This is probably more common is passive optional or
low value sounding language. So you can read this.

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I won't read the thing the whole email out, but these are the little details
I'm talking about that can take your average reply rate from 2% to 3% just
by

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eliminating this stuff. So I highlighted in red everything that comes across
as passive. I hope this message finds you

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well. Reaching out to hopefully set up a time potentially act as a
resource. I

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would love to. It sounds like a favor. Like you're hoping for this, but you're
not expecting them to say yes. Get a

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better understanding. No one wants to teach you or give you a better

understanding. You're supposed to have the understanding and how we can be of

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assistance. Warmest regards. Again, there's a million different variations of this. Some of them are debatable, but

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in general, you want to be reducing or eliminating passive optional sounding language and replacing it with stronger,

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more assumptive language that implies you're expecting this meeting to happen and that it will be valuable for them.

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We're going to get into examples of that here in a second. So, I'm getting into the meme game here because this is

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honestly the transition I think a lot of reps go through when they're new. They come in and they're like, "You don't

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know anything yet." and you're like, "All right, I'm going to just tell them who I am, what we do, and why I'm relevant to them, and and try and get on

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the same page and set up a meeting this week." And then over time, you'll get, if you follow too many LinkedIn sales

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influencers, or you take your sales enablement training too literally from people who aren't actually in the role

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doing this, you'll get pulled into all this fancy nonsense, the show me and know me, personalize everything. Again,

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there's sometimes a time and place for that. But if you're an SDR and you're trying to book 10 15 plus meetings per

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month, you need to be sending a lot of emails that are high quality and you're not able to do that with these types of

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frameworks. And eventually you'll just pull back to realizing, you know what, let's get back to the basics. Here's who

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I am, why I'm reaching out to you, and what I want, and getting relevant messaging into the hands of relevant

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personas frequently as possible. So that getting into it, that is how you get

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prospects to respond. when they open your email, is it easy for them to understand who you are, why you're

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relevant to them, and could be valuable, and then what you want, and you're implying it. You're not asking for it.

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You're you're reaching out as a colleague, not as a customer service rep hoping to get some time on their

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calendar. So, fix your language. Keep it tight. Less is more. Generally, if you can accomplish the same message in five

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sentences as opposed to six, do that. Or even in less words or in shorter words.

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Eliminate fluff. replace replace weak optional phrasing with stronger, more assumptive language and write in a way

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that implies the meeting will happen. Not asking if they're interested, open to it, or if it would be worth their

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time. So, the reason most emails don't get replies is they are littered like that example I was just showing with

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passive optional sounding language that shows no conviction and why you're reaching out. Weak or unclear CTAs.

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Forget what that last example was, but worth exploring more. Worth a chat. I don't like those interestbased CTAs

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generally. I want stronger, more assumptive CTAs and poor persona alignment that goes into the list

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building and the coiling of the spring. Having nice organized lists by job title, industry, revenue band, whatever

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those key buying triggers are for your specific personas because ultimately you can get people to open it, read it, but

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if the message isn't valuable or actually relevant to the recipient, you're not going to get a lot of

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replies. So the cold email blueprint before we start getting into lots of

The cold email blueprint

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different examples just so you can understand the philosophy is designed with the following principles in mind

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and this is very similar to my cold call value statement framework but this is how it's structured in written word.

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It's still that who why structure. If you don't have success or a repeatable

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outbound blueprint for email yet start here. Who I am why I'm reaching out to you what I want. That's what every email

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clearly states. Assumptive framing. Emails are written with the expectation that this meeting makes sense, not

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questioning whether it does. Again, it's a free country. They can tell you no, but I want to go down swinging because I

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believe I'm valuable to this person. There's a specific reason I'm reaching out to them due to their title, industry, etc. And I'm expecting this

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meeting to happen. Not asking if they think it's open or valuable to it.

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not asking if they're interested or think it would be valuable. Sell the meeting, not the product. Sell yourself

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as a valuable resource to them moving forward in key business areas they care about and focus on setting up time.

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Persona first targeting. Adapt each email to the priorities and challenges specific to the recipient's role. So, as

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you'll see, all of the frameworks and email structures look very similar, but you're going to see where I changed

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phrasing or wording to make it sound more relevant to their specific job title or industry. And the goal is

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highquality at scale. Don't let any of these LinkedIn sales gurus tell you that volume doesn't matter. High quality

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volume at scale still works if you know how to structure and systematize it. You need a repeatable structure that that

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enables high velocity outreach without sacrificing quality or at least minimizing that sacrifice as much as

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possible. And some other goals of this cold email blueprint, it's built to scale with quality. You should be able

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to pull lists of hundreds of leads that all have the same job titles, industries, departments, locations,

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whatever, without sounding automated when you're reaching out because you're writing a message that's for CFOs that

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work in retail in the state of Utah or whatever. Follow-ups are mandatory, not optional. This is so key. We're going to

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go into follow-ups, but follow-ups generally generate about 70 to 80% of

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email meetings from my experience. So, we're going to put all this work to doing the first email, right? And the

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follow-ups are generally meant to go get them to read that first message

more carefully. But without the follow-ups,

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the first emails and all the work you're doing is pretty much for nothing. Simple to implement an easy ABAB cadence and

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repeatable templates. So, you don't need to overthink or do research in between every email. You can just focus on

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execution. And then our goal is to hit leads decisively and then move on. short

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and focused sequences that are designed to match the assumptive email tone. If you were reaching out to someone and it

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was actually important, like a colleague, like you're not trying to book a sales meeting and it was important and they hadn't responded

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after a day, you'd probably follow up within 24 to 48 hours. So, I don't want to see you guys using these once a week,

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every Monday automated cadences. I get these and it's so obvious that I'm just in some sequence if and if I don't

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respond a few more times, they'll go away. We don't want to seem like we're we're automating things. So, this is the

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way to visualize it. We're sending out these emails and follow-ups. Once we get responses, they're now in the funnel.

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And the response could either be in a best case. Yeah, sure. I'm free on Friday. Feel free to send me over an invite. The better we get at writing

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these emails, the more this will happen. You'll get plenty of take me off your list. Never call. Never reach out to me

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again. How'd you get my contact information? Just call those hard nos. make a note and move on. Otherwise,

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we're going to get objections or questions like, "Hey, thanks for reaching

out, but we already used this solution," or, "I don't know if I'm the

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right person for this." So, we want to be prepared with an objection handling bank, which we'll get into as well. But

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now, getting into the nitty-gritty, some examples. All of these are going to look

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slightly different. Don't stress if this isn't the exact structure that you would use. You can make tweaks to this, but

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I'm trying to highlight and point out where I answer these three questions. So, I call this one just a general

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outbound variation. If you're reaching out to net new prospects, in its simplest form, you say, "Good morning."

Real email template examples by persona and industry

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Let's say we're reaching out to VPs of IT in this example. My name is Conor Murray and I'm part of the IT

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infrastructure team at XYZ. We work with IT departments to modernize data environments and reduce operational

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risk. You can get more specific than that and you should. I'm just using this as a general example. Our focus is on

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priorities related to infrastructure consolidation, storage reliability, and business continuity. We specifically

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help teams reduce unplanned downtime, improve backup and recovery SLAs's, and simplify multi-state data management by

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leveraging our high availability storage platforms and automation ready hardware. I'm looking to set some time for an

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introduction to understand your priorities and see if there's a fit. Do you

have availability the week of September 29th? Thanks in advance,

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Connor. So, you may not even this might not even make sense to you or these aren't the types of personas you reach

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out to, but in its simplest form, I told them here's who I am, the Conor Murray

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and the team I'm a part of. And basically with what's highlighted, I'm trying to say enough things, priorities,

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challenges, outcomes that this person is likely to care about that they pause,

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look at it, and determine, hey, this might be worth setting up more time to talk about. A lot of this is a timing

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thing. Maybe storage reliability, the first time you send this email, isn't relevant to them. And then two months

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later, you send the same email and all of a sudden storage reliability, they had some issue, it comes up in an

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internal meeting. And now, hey, you know what? I want to talk more about that. So, we're based on the persona, in this

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case, a VP of IT. I'm saying here's who I am, why I'm reaching out to them, which is essentially the types of

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priorities that I work on, and how we help teams like them at a high level, and then stating what I want is time on

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their calendar in a given specific week. There's lots of examples and ways you can go about asking for that, but

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this is the if you don't have email structure in place yet or you're doing way too fancy over-the-top tactics that

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aren't scalable, this is a repeatable framework that just about all of you

can use regardless of where you work, the

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personas you reach out to, industries, etc. So, let's get into another example.

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I call this kind of a more formal account management. This can work well if you're reaching out to an above the

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line person like an executive at an account that's already a customer. However, they don't need to be an

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existing customer for this type of template to work as well. I'll explain that in a second, but looks a little

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different, but same thing. It answers who I am, why I'm reaching out, and what I want. I'm Connor Murray. In this case,

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I'm part of the ABC marketing team that supports organizations on digital engagement and customer life cycle

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strategy. Given your role, I wanted to introduce our team and get aligned with the broader marketing priorities you're driving this year. Most teams we work

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with are looking for a cleaner, more connected way to use their customer data so they can deliver stronger campaigns

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without adding extra lift to the team. Conversations usually focus on creating more consistency across owned channels

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and finding easier ways to turn that into predictable revenue. Do either the following times next week work for an

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introductory call? Couple bullet points with times and dates. looking forward to it assumptively, Connor. So, in this

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case, I more imply although what I tell people is if you're a sales rep and you

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have a territory, you are responsible for supporting that organization, whether they're a customer or not. So,

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you can use language like I'm responsible for supporting XYZ company. But in this case, it's a little more

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formal and I'm answering who I am. In this case, you can see how it's same

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same concept. I'm just now I'm at a marketing company and these are the types of priorities and challenges that

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we work on and outcomes we deliver. So I could probably put together a list of

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100 VPs of marketing if I was an SDR at this company. Get them all on a list and be confident that this is going to be a

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relevant template for them. And I'm going to show you you can even take it a step further. Let's say they all work in

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retail as an example. We can use more retail specific language while keeping

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the same structure. All right. Now, this next example I call kind of a hybrid variation between the two that I just

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showed. In this case, it's going to be a VP of FPNA, financial planning and analysis, if you sold financial

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management or EPM software, but it still answers the who you are, why you're reaching out to them specifically, and

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what you want. So, in this case, good morning. We've yet to be introduced. My name is Connor Murray, and I'm part of, in this case, the retail solutions team

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at XYZ, responsible for supporting our EPM applications. That stands for enterprise performance management. So

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planning, reporting, financial close. My team focuses on priorities related to inventory forecasting and cost

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containment. We work with finance teams to shorten planning cycles, reduce manual processes, and improve forecast

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collaboration by centralizing models and data across retail organizations. I'm looking to set some time for an

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introduction as my team would be your main point of contact for any priorities you may have in these areas going

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forward. What does your availability look like for next week? Best regards, Connor. So, in this case, you can see

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how let's say I had a territory and maybe one of my account executives strictly focused on our retail vertical.

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I could take one of our top job titles, VPs of FPNA, add a hundred of them that

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work in retail, and be confident that this is a good, relevant, targeted message for their job description, their

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industry. And really what you can see the the what's highlighted is what you want to play around with based on what

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you know like the language and phrasing you believe is highest likelihood to land or resonate with your prospects. A

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lot of this comes from hearing them when you actually talk to them on the phone or on discovery calls. Hey, we struggle

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with the XYZ or we're focused on blank going into FY26. If you hear stuff

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repeatably, that's what you want to insert in here. That's the type of stuff that can make 1 to 2% differences to

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your reply rate. But I'm just trying to name priorities and challenges, outcomes that I think a VP of FPNA in retail is

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likely to care about. For example, inventory forecasting. That's not something I would say to someone in

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financials, like a VP of FPNA and that works at a bank because they don't have inventory. So here's examples of where

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you can use the same structure, same framework, but replace slightly different phrasing based on what you

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know is relevant for that specific industry. Shorten planning cycles. Another way you could have phrased it is

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same store sales forecasting for retail. If it was life science, you could say

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something like clinical trial planning or clinical trial forecasting. Again, really what I want to drive home here is

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this framework in that you can take and adapt depending on your specific personas, industries,

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etc. So, now let's do another one. We've done it. We've done I think HR, finance.

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Now, let's say you're doing fleet management. Who you are? Why reaching out? What you want? My name is Conor

23:12

Murray. I'm part of the construction team. If you're focused on the construction vertical at Fleet Core Solutions, we work with fleet ops teams

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in the construction space to improve visibility and cut down on manual admin work. Our focus is on priorities related

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to blank blank and blank vehicle vehicle tracking, fleet visibility, driver performance management. They usually

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bring us in to reduce driver admin time, improve route efficiency, and automate reporting on driver and vehicle activity

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through our straightforward tracking system and up-to-date fleet information. I'm looking to set some time, yada yada.

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what does your availability look like? Thanks in advance, Connor. So, yet another example, totally different

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industry, totally different persona. You again, if you don't want to name three priorities or three outcomes, you could

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stick to two. I'm just trying to give you a little more than what you likely need and showing who you are, why you're

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reaching out, what you want, repeatable, good, solid framework to get going with if you're focused on email outbound. Oh,

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and here's the HR example. I think this is the last one. In this case, part of the capital site workforce applications

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team. We work with HR teams relying on manual onboarding processes, disconnected HR systems, limited

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visibility into employee engagement metrics, and our focus is on automating onboarding and and benefits admin,

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centralizing employee records, providing clear insight into retention risk in order to help HR leaders both reduce

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term turnover, accelerate hiring timelines. going for the meeting. What does your availability look like on

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Thursday or Friday this week? So, I hope you can start to see how this is a repeatable framework. But now, I want to

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go into how to uplevel this framework if you have additional information or trying to be more targeted. Everything

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I've just showed you up to this point is good for high volume email prospecting at scale, keeping the best, highest

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quality that you can. But the goal of that is to be able to pull up 80, 100 or

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more contacts that all fit the same job title, department, buying trigger, whatever it is, and send the same

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message to all of them with a high likelihood it will be relevant just by changing their name and the name of the

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the company they work for, keeping all else equal. But let's say you want to go that observation, personalization, show

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me, you know me route, but you want to combine it with the framework I've already taught you. Here's an example of

How to personalize without breaking scale

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how you can do that. So in this case, good morning VP of IT. I saw blank. Your team recently expanded its data center

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operations and wanted to reach out about modernizing infrastructure to reduce operational risk. We typically support

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IT orgs that are going through similar shifts. I'm Connor Murray. My name is Connor Murray from the IT infrastructure

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team at XYZ. We work with IT departments on and the rest of this is very similar

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infrastructure consolidation, storage reliability, business continuity and we typically help teams do blank, blank and

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blank and then again going for the time. So this is how you can combine the who, why, what structure. You can see where

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everything's highlighted. But if you do want if you saw on LinkedIn some CFO or

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in this case VP of IT at one of your top accounts did expand its data center operations, well then you can use that

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in your first line to increase the likelihood they see it and believe you're an actual person reaching out and

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capture their attention, but still maintain this who, why, what structure.

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Another example, contextled outreach. This is really good. I actually think this is the best form of email if you're

26:34

able to do it which and usually you would have had to have met or at least spoken with some people at the company

26:40

on the phone or maybe you held a discovery call with someone else and it's I call it contextled outreach. So

26:46

good morning VP of IT. spoke with blank if you feel comfortable like actually

26:51

name dropping the person or you could just say I spoke with some folks on your IT team or something and understand that

26:57

blank and blank improving storage reliability and reducing unplanned down unplanned downtime are key focuses for

27:03

your team this year. If you actually learn from someone at the organization about a priority that they're focused on

27:09

for that quarter or that year and you know that's what's coming up on their internal meetings then use that in your

27:14

first sentence. I wanted to reach out because we typically support IT orgs working through those same initiatives

27:19

and then the rest is largely the same. Again, I'm Connor Murray, who I am, why I'm reaching out, and then what I want.

27:27

So, here's how you can combine that same who, why, what structure, repeatable at scale, but easily add some specific

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context on top of that and maintain that threebody paragraph structure that's proven to work really well over emails.

27:42

So now what I tell people is especially when you're just building outbound email, start with you don't have to boil

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the ocean and get too nitty-gritty with the coiling of the spring. You hear me

27:54

talk about that a lot. You don't need to get to controllers that work in retail

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at retail retailers that do between 20 and 30 million and are growing exactly

28:05

at, you know, 10% per year with under a,000 employees. You don't need to get to that level. Start with your most

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common job titles, your most common departments, industries. Have like three

28:16

to five of your bread and butter that you focus on getting right first before kind of going down the curve to more

28:22

niche personas. But once you start doing that, a very useful way to think about it is I like to think of them in persona

Persona levels and how to adapt messaging

28:30

levels of which there's three. And that's one is end users, two is kind of

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middle management, and three is executives. Just to simplify it. In other words, level one is ground floor.

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That's like the endto-end users. Like me and you, if you're an SDR and AE, you're

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a level one. You're the people actually using the systems on a day-to-day basis. Like if you were selling CRM for Gong or

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Salesforce, the SDRs and AEES would be your level one enduser employees. And their goals are generally they're

28:59

focused on how can I save time, simplify manual tasks, reduce friction so that I can execute. And some examples are SDRs,

29:06

fleet dispatchers, recruiters. Level two would be more middle management. They're more at the ops level. They're usually

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managing these end users directly and they own team KPIs and their goals. They're not always in the systems as

29:19

heavily that are being sold, but their goals are to improve efficiency, process, and performance of their team.

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So some examples would be sales managers or directors, fleet ops managers, directors of IT. And then level three

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are executives and budget holders. Those are generally to keep it simple VPs and above. They're generally not in the

29:39

tools as much at all, but they own budgets and strategic direction.

They're more focused on ROI, risk reduction,

29:45

alignment with overall business goals. And these can be VPs, suite, department heads. The reason this is useful to

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separate out is because again, if we're going for 1 to 2% improvements in our

29:57

reply rates and conversion rates, what an end user will care about is different than what a level three executive will

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care about in an email. So, here are some examples of what that looks like

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using that fleet dispatcher example. So, we're going to show a level one template, level two, level three. All of

30:15

them look, if you didn't read them yet, they all structurally look the same, but I tried to highlight what I changed to

30:21

make it more relevant for that specific persona level. So, in level one, it follows that who, why, what structure,

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but in this one, I talk about what we work on is automating activity logging because they're probably the ones having

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to log that stuff manually on a day-to-day, not the COO. So, that is what's more likely to resonate with

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them. Reduce back and forth with drivers and get clear visibility into who's where, and when. Level two, the fleet

30:45

ops manager. Reduce driver admin time. So more team KPI focused, increase

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visibility across their teams by automating reporting tied to fleet and driver activity. And then for the COO, I

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talked about strategic priorities around fleet visibility, driver performance optimization, and that operational

31:03

leaders usually bring us in to increase accountability across their field teams and create more scalable oversight

31:09

across regions. So if you worked in in fleet management, I don't know if these are the exact ways to do it. This is

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just the way to think about it because again, what a level one fleet dispatcher

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is likely to resonate to in an email is very different than what a COO would resonate. So I don't think you need to

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start here and I don't even think you need to start with three persona levels. Usually you can start with just two and

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call it above the line. Call it managers and above and below the line. But what I don't want you guys to fall into the

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trap of is creating a different template for a manager of IT versus a director of IT versus a VP of IT. All of them can

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probably fit within the same template, but yeah, you want to have a different template for an IT analyst than a CIO

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for sure. So at least have those above the line, below the line templates that you build out. So we focused up to this

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point all on crafting targeted valuable messaging, persona based targeting at

32:04

scale, highquality at scale, casting that hook so that we get a good relevant message into the hands of relevant

Follow-ups and why most meetings come from them

32:10

personas as frequently as possible. But now part two once we you can't have

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success over email if you don't do part one right. But now that we've done that all that work now we need to focus on

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effective follow-ups which is where most meetings end up getting booked. So,

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first, the reason we follow up more specifically is that follow-ups reinforce the value of our outreach.

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They set the expectation that a meeting will happen and show the prospect that a real person, not an automated sequence,

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is reaching out to them with a specific purpose in mind. Follow-ups signal professionalism, intent, and

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consistency. Even if we are automating or doing this at scale, we don't want it

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to come across or read that we are. Because again, if you actually were reaching out to someone with an

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important message, you would follow up consistently and you wouldn't be trying to sell yourself overly sell yourself on

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these follow-ups. You would more be wanting them to respond to the initial message that you reached out to them about. So, there's many reasons people

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get way too worked up when they're not getting enough replies on their first emails. Here are some of the many reasons that prospects don't reply right

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away. One, they're busy or distracted. That happens to me all the time. I get an email, I actually think it's pretty good. I might respond to it, but then I

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get pulled into a meeting or pulled into something or get a call, I get distracted and it it just completely

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slips my mind and I don't get back to it. But if they followed up with me, I would have. They for again it's kind of similar. They forget to respond. A lot

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of times they're waiting on internal alignment. They actually find your email valuable. They forward it. If they're

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like a manager, they forward it to their VP and they're like, "Hey, should we get on this call or do you think do you think this would be worth the time?" And

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that VP doesn't get back to them because they're busy. And then

because you don't follow up, the manager doesn't follow up

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with them. That happens all the time. A lot of times they're not convinced yet you're a real person or a relevant

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person. That's totally fair. Email is becoming pretty saturated. People are blasting it out. Usually when I get an

34:06

outbound email, I am just assuming I'm part of some cadence and that this person isn't actually reaching out to me

34:11

directly. But the follow-ups are what reinforce that. Or most commonly, the timing simply wasn't right when they saw

34:18

the first email. That's why I always tell people you only need to wait 4 weeks on the early end. Usually 6 to 8

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weeks. You can reach out with the same email in just about the same follow-ups repeatedly, like way more frequently and

34:30

often than you think because a lot of times it's just a timing thing. If you sell financial close software, you reach

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out, you know, in June when it's not relevant, August when it's not relevant, September, but then you reach out in, I

34:43

don't know, February the next year after they just closed the books for the prior year. now they're like it's fresh on their mind. So a lot of times this is

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just a timing thing. So the follow-up approach to start out with shorten the timeline. I don't want to see any of

34:55

these 30-day 45day cadences, 15 touch points. You want to hit them early and

35:02

move them on because the the overly complicated 15 touch point cadences is what makes you come across like you're

35:08

actually automating the cadence and that you're not a real person. So, one main email followed by three to four sharp,

35:14

concise follow-ups over I recommend a 7 to 10 day period and rinse and repeat.

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Rather than after those three to four emails, five including the first one, rather than going to 15, take the time

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you were going to spend on those next 10, and just direct them towards a new fresh list that hasn't been contacted.

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Because I promise you, after five emails, the email reply rates drop dramatically and it kind of starts to

35:38

devalue yourself in the prospect's eyes and they're less likely to respond to you if you were to email them again down

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the line. So, you can return to non-responsive lists every 6 to 8 weeks

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rather than dragging out those long cadences. So, prioritize fresh lists,

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hit them hard, early, often, and again, 70 to 80% of meetings booked via email will come from these follow-ups, not the

36:01

first message. So, here is just one of many examples of what that four email

36:07

follow-up cadence can look like. And I tried to give off the general vibe of what I'm going for, if you want to call

36:13

it that. So, follow-up one usually comes within 24 to 48 hours max. Never go more

Simple follow-up sequences that feel human

36:19

than 48 hours, unless it's a weekend lapsing, but two business days. Never go more than two business days. The first

36:25

follow-up is kind of a simple nudge where you give them the benefit of the doubt. It can sound something like, "Hey, blank. Just following up to make

36:30

sure my note reached you. Does Thursday or Friday morning work for a quick introduction? Thanks again, Connor." Give them the benefit of the doubt.

36:37

People get busy. They're not trustworthy of people in their email inbox. Fair. Follow-up. Two is where I show what I

36:44

call slight professional dissatisfaction. You're not being rude, but you're kind of signaling like, "Hey, I am a real person. I actually am

36:51

reaching out to you, and I'd appreciate a response to what I just said." So, it could sound something like, "Please let

36:56

me know if either of those dates work for you. Please give me your thoughts on this. Please let me know your thoughts on this when you have a moment. Thanks,

37:03

Connor." The third one, I'm constantly playing around with these, but right now, what's working is what I call an

37:10

assumptive breakup, where you say, "Let me know if it makes sense to revisit this conversation later on. I'm happy to

37:15

reconnect in February." Put it like a month or two out. If it's late December,

37:20

say February. If it's early January, say February. um I don't know if it's late

37:25

February, say April, um just planning the next couple weeks and would like to close the loop. Either way, you're kind

37:32

of guiltting them a little bit. And then followup for the last resort is to just your name. They'd be like, "John, I'm

37:38

assuming this isn't a priority currently and we can revisit another quarter." Again, so many different ways you could

37:44

go about this and I'm always open to seeing what people are using. But the goal is short, concise, easy to

37:50

implement follow-ups at scale that give you another shot on net of getting a response to your request to meet that

37:57

you left in the first message. So, they should be directing the prospect towards the initial email and request to meet,

38:04

not creating these brand like these brand new from scratch follow-ups that totally disregard the fact that you

38:11

already sent them a valuable message like, "Hey, hey, so and so saw companies focused on blank. Here's an example of

38:17

how we've worked in Xindustry." And you're disregarding the fact, you're devaluing the fact that you already sent

38:23

them a valuable, relevant message. And it kind of again increases the perception in their head that you're

38:29

just automating a cadence and we'll do and say whatever you can in order to book this meeting. So getting back to

38:36

the blue blueprint, the emails and follow-ups are implementing that at scale are what we're doing to the best

38:42

of our ability to get as many of these that we can. Once we get these, there's only three possible outcomes. Best case,

38:48

yes. Worst case, hard no. Most commonly you get some sort of objection

38:54

hesitation question as to why they don't think it makes sense to meet. And then we want to be as prepared as possible

39:00

with these with an objection handling bank. And the framework I use is to

essentially acknowledge their concern

Handling objections over email

39:05

and tell them it makes sense to meet anyway, not to write a brand new email or try and convince them or handle their

39:11

objection over email. So an example of this and here I'll show you why it's important on the right too, but an

39:17

example is, hey, it wouldn't make sense for us to meet. We're already a customer. we already use blank vendor, blank solution and it sound instead of

39:24

trying to oh how's that solution going for you or see here how we were able to help this company reduce their close

39:29

process by 35% by making the move that's not going to convince them over email mo

39:35

those don't get replies so we're going to say something like hi name thanks for the insight or appreciate the insight

39:41

the idea here is just for us to get introduced and be a resource and point of contact at blank company we work with

39:46

a lot of xyz customers so if there's ever a fit we can move forward but it It would at least make sense to get a line

39:51

for the year. Brief 15-minute call would be greatly appreciated. Do either of those dates work for you? Thanks in

39:56

advance, Connor. You'd be surprised if you just keep it focused on selling the meeting rather than selling why you'd be

40:03

a better solution than the current vendor you're using. That is a way easier sell. Again, if you can't sell

40:08

them on a 15-minute meeting as the primary driver for taking the meeting

in the first place, you're not going to

40:14

sell them on switching vendors on an off-the cuff email as the reason they take the meeting. So, what you want to

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do for the most common ones you repeatedly get, this helped me a lot as an SDR, is create an a bank, an

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objection handling bank, so that literally next time you get some sort of similar objection like this, you can

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just look it up in your OneNote, wherever you store it, and you have an outofthe-box response ready to go. You

40:38

don't have to spend 15 minutes typing up or coming up with a good response to it. You can always make little tweaks based

40:44

on what you know about the prospect or the industry or the company, but you want a good starting point to save you

40:49

time. So, it prevents the need from crafting an objection response every

40:54

single time you get one. It's you save proven responses to common objections to have a strong starting point. It's

41:01

something you can keep building and refining over time. Small improvements compound quickly and that remember the

41:06

key input is responses aka you're selling time. You're selling the meeting here. driving responses that give you

41:13

shots on that. So, in cold email engine, we have an objection handling bank for all of the most common objections that

41:19

we've continued building out and refining. Here's just a couple more examples. They give you the category, we

41:25

don't have a budget. They can sound different, but they fall under this category. Thanks for sharing that. Definitely makes sense. This

41:31

conversation is not about budget or immediate purchasing decisions. It's more about getting introduced and making sure you have a point of contact when

41:37

the timing is right. A brief 15minute call would be greatly appreciated. Do either of those dates work for you? Thanks, Connor. We already handle this

41:44

in-house, something like that. Appreciate the insight. Totally understand. This wouldn't be replacing anything you're doing internally. It's

41:50

just to introduce myself and be a point of contact here as new priorities arise or any additional support is ever

41:55

needed. A brief 15-minute call would be greatly appreciated. Do you have availability this week? Thanks, Connor.

42:01

So, different objections, same framework. And look, if they respond to this again, well, now they're pretty

42:07

engaged. And that's when you can start showing them any specific documentation you have on how you've helped customers

42:14

go from handling it in-house to your solution and what some of the business outcomes were. That's when you can do

42:19

it. But my first goal when handling objections over email is to just double down and sell the meeting. Now, getting

42:26

towards some of the nittier, grittier details, subject lines. I get asked about this a lot. The goal with subject

Subject lines that work

42:33

lines, in my opinion, is to just not shoot yourself in the foot. Don't lose the email with the subject line, which

42:39

is what so many people do. They actually write pretty good emails, but

their subject lines just come across as fake,

42:44

salesy, markety. So, things to avoid. Let's 10x your fleet efficiency. Connor saw this and thought of you. Your

42:50

competition's already doing this. Starting to drop percentages and business outcomes, improve your ops

42:56

efficiency by 32%. Or just weird ones. Can you help me? This is the stuff that can get you flagged as spam, too.

43:02

Subject lines that are totally fine. Again, if we're going for repeatable at scale, that actually works. Their name,

43:10

your name, intro or introduction is a totally fine subject line. Their name, your name, the name of your company.

43:17

Their company, your company, intro. And then if you want to start getting into that personalized subject line category,

43:24

if you know there's a specific priority or outcome that this list of people would care about or is likely to care

43:30

about, you can throw that in there like fleet tracking for XYZ company. Or you could combine it with one of these like

43:37

John/Connor fleet tracking, something like that. Or intro XYZ's fleet team.

43:43

Generally aim for three or four words max. And it should be about what the email is about. Cuz look, you could hook

43:50

them with one of these, but then if your email is not about improving ops efficiency by 32% or can you help me and

43:56

you're not asking for help, they're they're just going to write you off and not reply. You're going to do more harm than good. So these are about what the

44:03

emails are actually about. They work. They're scalable. You shouldn't

need to spend a minute in between emails

44:09

thinking of a subject line. The goal is to be able to copy and paste a repeatable framework. So simple, clear,

44:14

easy to understand at a glance. That's the goal. Bottom line, less is more. Overthinking subject lines will

44:20

generally kill your replies and slow you down. Don't try to win with the subject line. Win with the email. You'll just

44:26

sound salesy and manipulative if you come across as trying to win the subject line. Clarity beats cleverness. People

Calendar invites that increase show rates

44:33

open and read emails that they understand. Now, lastly, let's get into calendar

44:39

invites. I think this is one of the most overlooked but important topics when it comes to really outbound in general even

44:45

for cold calling or link however you're booking meetings but they are emails so I'm putting it in this category a lot of

44:51

these are some bad examples that are common that I want to go through but at least they're trying here a lot of

44:56

people don't even send out they they don't put anything in the calendar invite it's just blank and it'll say

45:02

like Connor-Joh intro because the problem is you book these meetings a lot of times on a

45:07

Monday and it gets scheduled for Thursday or Friday or even the next week. And all this time goes by, they

45:14

barely remember what was just a blip in their day agreeing to a meeting. And if you don't have context in there, they're

45:20

going to forget what this was about and view it as just a skippable meeting or they were 50/50 when they accepted it.

45:26

They were in a good mood, they'd had their coffee, and then on Friday morning when they're looking at their calendar, they're like, "Ah, no, screw this." So,

45:32

you need to have something for them to bite off on in the calendar invite. So, some examples I commonly see is overly

45:39

thanking them in the calendar invite. Thank you so much. You like act like you've been there before. Looking forward to don't say learning about your

45:46

role. They don't want to teach you about their role. You're supposed to know about it. Agenda. It'll be too fluffy

45:51

and not again not give them enough to bite off on. Introductions. That one's actually fine. Learn more about your

45:57

role and responsibilities. Share a bit about what we do. Discuss potential synergies. Let me know if there's

46:03

anything you'd like to add. really excited for the conversation. This will kill like you put so much work in. If

46:09

you don't get high uh show rates, look at your calendar invite um agendas

46:14

because they're probably weak and fluffy like this. Here's another example. Thanks again. Don't thank them. I'm

46:20

looking forward to an open conversation where we can learn about each other's goals, agenda, quick introductions,

46:25

overview of what we do, hear more about your priorities, see if there's alignment. This one's better than this

46:31

one, but this is still too highlevel fluffy. They don't like you could be a sales rep at Salesforce or

46:39

data bricks or snow. Like they don't know like they it should be clear what this meeting is going to be about. So

46:45

here's a better structure that's repeatable. You can use chat GPT to help this. We actually have GPTs that do this

46:51

in AI sales accelerator, but there's lots of variations of this. Having a simple attendees list, it just makes it

46:58

look a little bit more professional. So even if it's just one person, AB, ABC University, if it was some sort of

47:04

university you were reaching out to, attendees, John Smith, VP of infrastructure, and then your company attendees, Conor Murray, enterprise

47:11

account executive, an SC if they're joining, and then proposed agenda doesn't need to be anything fancy.

47:16

Introductions is fine because generally these conversations start with intutions. discuss ABC's universities

47:23

and then whatever it is your company does current infrastructure monitoring and observability approach company like

47:29

your company overview and higher education approach discuss next steps I like to throw in this if any ju just to

47:35

signal I'm not going to hound them or force a next step if it's not a fit but at least when they open this email now

47:40

they're like oh right I wanted to talk about monitoring observability and I'm going to hear a specific company

47:46

approach to my industry that's a little bit more to bite off on here's another example if We want to add even more

47:51

context where the attendees are the same and then the proposed agenda just gives a little bit more context under each

47:58

bullet or yeah each bullet. So current infrastructure landscape and then something more to bite off on key

48:04

monitoring challenges, tool set, operational priorities, how our company is working with similar institutions,

48:10

example outcomes, visibility improvements, reduced MTR, meantime to resolution, like an actual business KPI

48:17

this person probably cares about, and then again overview of our company's solutions and higher education approach,

48:22

next step if any. So this if you just have the repeatable framework, this should take you almost no time to do.

48:28

Less than 30 seconds to get out the door and ship it, but you're just going to look way more professional and it's going to greatly increase the odds that

48:34

they show up to this meeting. You put in all the work, you booked the meeting. Let's make sure they show up. So don't

48:40

overlook calendar invites. So I hope you all got value out of this. Again, as I

48:45

was saying earlier, if you want more hands-on guidance, actually taking these frameworks, implementing them repeatably

48:51

at scale, using the ABAB framework, actually having me dive into the

48:56

personas and and working on you with the messaging. You can check out cold email engine. I lead the live calls in there

49:02

every single week. So, hope to see you in there and hope you all got value out of this cold email guide and I'll see

49:10

you in the next